

Ellen Poulsen

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EDUCATION

2025–Present	B.S. Aerospace Engineering California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo	(GPA: 3.751/4.0)
2021–2025	Sheldon High School, Eugene OR International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme Graduate	(GPA: 3.98/4.00)
2023	Recipient of the Oregon State Seal of Biliteracy in Spanish	

WORK EXPERIENCE

Test Engineering Intern — Empirical Systems Aerospace *June 2026 — Aug. 2026*
San Luis Obispo, CA

As a test engineering intern at Empirical Systems Aerospace, I worked collaboratively in the development of servo testing procedures, test stand, and software. Using python script and NI equipment, I developed software to test servo frequency response as essential in flight maneuvers. Calibration and loading of known inertia values were included in the design. The research and development included both PWM and CAN bus control systems, and emphasized the importance of accurate timing synchronization throughout data collection.

PROJECTS

Cal Poly Space Systems — Liquids Project

Team member developing a bipropellant liquid rocket engine and test stand, with the goal of full rocket integration. Embracing Cal Poly's "Learn by Doing" approach, we contribute to development of propulsion, controls, and testing. On the SILLE leadership team, aiming to improve member retention and education through mentorship and guidance through construction of mini liquid rocket engines for the 2026-2027 school year.

Sheldon Astronomy Club — Construction of Dobsonian Telescope

[Link to Article](#)

A co-president of Sheldon Astronomy Club for four years I organized weekly presentations on astrophysics, observational astronomy, and space news. Led construction of an 8-inch Dobsonian telescope in partnership with local astronomy club. The telescope was featured in the August 2025 edition of *Sky & Telescope*.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Sheldon High School Associated Student Body (ASB)

Serving as ASB Executive President, I oversaw and led more than 80 students. This included a variety of school events, while also acting as a student-admin liaison advocating on behalf of my peers and faculty. This experience showed me how to stand up for issues I believe in, communicate effectively, and work collaboratively alongside others.

Society of Women Engineers at Cal Poly

The Society of Women Engineers members work to advocate for and support women underrepresented in their fields. Participating in SWE has given me the opportunity to advance access to education in my community and inspire the next generation of girls in engineering and technology.

Freelance Photography

Experience working in professional photography, including for notable organizations such as the Eugene Marathon, Eugene Ballet Company, and Insta Ballet. I worked to plan, direct, and process photos for client projects. These opportunities have given me confidence in my communication skills and allowed me to connect with my community through my artistic vision.